The Northeast

The Northeast Culture was one of the earliest cultures that interacted with the newly arrived Europeans. This culture lived along today's Atlantic coastline from Canada down to North Carolina in the United States and as far as the Mississippi River. The people who lived in this area are also divided into two key groupings by scholars: the Algonquian speakers that lived along the coastline and the Iroquoian speakers who settled near the riverbanks and lakes. The Algonquian included the Delaware, Shawnee, Fox, Pequot and the Menominee tribes whereas the Iroquoian included the Tuscarora, Seneca, Erie, Oneida, and the Cayuga tribes. The Algonquian had a larger population but the Iroquoians lived in permanent settlements they did not have to move every now and then.

The Iroquoians had a very aggressive nature. They would continuously raid those they hadn't formed ties with and their raiding only increased with the arrival of the Europeans. Although it was difficult to do so, the Native Americans were forced to set their differences aside to fight against the European newcomers. The Europeans were smart and in many cases attempted to make the natives fight each other instead. As more Europeans arrived made their way west, the Native American communities began to dwindle even more.